

2026 Southern Outer Banks Open Poker Rules

Saturday October 17, 2026

1. Event Schedule:

4:30 PM. to 6:00 PM.: Arrive at 808 Emerald Dr, get settled, and buy chips for the tournament which will start promptly at 6 PM. The buy-in is \$40. Digital payment is preferred (Venmo or Apple Cash), but if all you have is regular cash, we'll figure out how to make that work. We will have college football games on TV all evening. Pizza and snacks will be provided, and you're welcome to bring your favorite alcoholic beverages for personal consumption. There is no smoking allowed inside the house.

6 PM to 11-ish PM: No Limit Texas Hold'em Tournament (20-minute blind levels). We will start with two tables with a roughly equal number of players assigned by random card draw. There is a \$40 buy-in for the tournament and there are no rebuys. You are eliminated from a tournament once you lose all your chips. As players are eliminated, the tables will be consolidated as necessary by the SOBO organizers such that each table has about the same number of players. Player moves will be decided by high-card draw. Standard Casino rules will apply to any disputes. Any disputes not resolved by the players involved will be decided at the sole discretion of the tournament host in an effort to make a fair decision.

Late arrivals: Players may join a tournament late, as long as they start play before the end of Level 3. After joining the tournament, players must make up any blinds that they missed.

2. Chip Allocation

Each player starts with **\$5,000** in chips (100 big blinds)

20 White (\$25 chips)	\$500
10 Red (\$50 chips)	\$500
10 Black (\$100 chips)	\$1,000
6 Light Blue (\$500 chips)	\$3,000

Total: \$5,000

Other value-holding chips: **Green, \$1,000; Orange, \$5,000.**

3. Betting Levels and Blinds

Large Tournament (15 or more players, 20 minute levels)

<u>Level</u>	<u>Time</u>	<u>Blinds</u>
L1:	0:00 - 0:20	\$25 (Small Blind); \$50 (Big Blind)
L2:	0:20 - 0:40	\$50/100
L3:	0:40 - 1:00	\$75/150
L4:	1:00 - 1:20	\$100/200
L5:	1:20 - 1:40	\$150/300
B1:	1:40 - 1:55	15 minute break (remove \$25 and \$50 chips)
L6:	1:55 - 2:15	\$200/400
L7:	2:15 - 2:35	\$300/600
L8:	2:35 - 2:55	\$400/800
L9:	2:55 - 3:15	\$500/1,000
L10:	3:15 - 3:35	\$1,000/2,000
B2:	3:35 - 3:50	15 minute break (remove \$100 chips)
L11:	3:50 - 4:10	\$1,500/3,000
L12:	4:10 - 4:30	\$2,000/4,000
L13:	4:30 - 4:50	\$3,000/6,000
L14:	4:50 - 5:10	\$4,000/8,000
L15:	5:10 - 5:30	\$5,000/10,000
B3:	5:30 - 5:40	10 minute break (remove \$500 chips)
L16+:	5:40 +	\$10,000/20,000 and Blinds will double every 10 minutes

Smaller Tournament (14 or fewer players - 20 minute levels)

<u>Level</u>	<u>Time</u>	<u>Blinds</u>
L1:	0:00 - 0:20	\$25 (Small Blind); \$50 (Big Blind)
L2:	0:20 - 0:40	\$50/100
L3:	0:40 - 1:00	\$75/150
L4:	1:00 - 1:20	\$100/200
L5:	1:20 - 1:40	\$150/300
B1:	1:40 - 1:55	15 minute break (remove \$25 and \$50 chips)
L6:	1:55 - 2:15	\$200/400
L7:	2:15 - 2:35	\$300/600
L8:	2:35 - 2:55	\$400/800
L9:	2:55 - 3:15	\$500/1,000
L10:	3:15 - 3:35	\$800/1,600
B2:	3:35 - 3:50	15 minute break (remove \$100 chips)
L11:	3:50 - 4:10	\$1,000/2,000
L12:	4:10 - 4:30	\$1,500/3,000
L13:	4:30 - 4:50	\$2,000/4,000
L14:	4:50 - 5:10	\$3,000/6,000
L15:	5:10 - 5:30	\$4,000/8,000

B3: 5:30- 5:40 10 minute break (remove \$500 chips)
L16+: 5:40 + \$5,000/10,000 and Blinds will double every 10 minutes

Heads-Up Rules: When just two players remain, the dealer will post the small blind. The other player will post the big blind. The dealer/small blind acts first before the flop but will act second thereafter.

4. Payout Schedule

Poker Tournament Payout Matrix

Top ~1/3 Paid Structure (9 to 20 Players) | 1.25 Buy-In Minimum Cash Structure

PAYOUT STRUCTURE PRINCIPLES

- **1.25 Buy-In Min-Cash:** The lowest paid rank always receives at least 1.25 buy-ins (25%+ profit).
- **No Tied Ranks:** Every paid place yields a strictly higher payout than the position below it.
- **Field Coverage:** Pays 27% to 33% of total entries (expanding to 6 paid spots at 19–20 players).

PLAYERS	TOTAL POT	PAID SPOTS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE	4TH PLACE	5TH PLACE	6TH PLACE
9	9.0	3 (33%)	5.0 55.6%	2.5 27.8%	1.5 16.7%	—	—	—
10	10.0	3 (30%)	5.5 55.0%	3.0 30.0%	1.5 15.0%	—	—	—
11	11.0	3 (27%)	6.0 54.5%	3.5 31.8%	1.5 13.6%	—	—	—
12	12.0	4 (33%)	6.0 50.0%	3.0 25.0%	1.75 14.6%	1.25 10.4%	—	—
13	13.0	4 (31%)	6.5 50.0%	3.5 26.9%	1.75 13.5%	1.25 9.6%	—	—
14	14.0	4 (29%)	7.0 50.0%	4.0 28.6%	1.75 12.5%	1.25 8.9%	—	—
15	15.0	5 (33%)	6.5 43.3%	3.5 23.3%	2.25 15.0%	1.5 10.0%	1.25 8.3%	—
16	16.0	5 (31%)	7.0 43.8%	4.0 25.0%	2.25 14.1%	1.5 9.4%	1.25 7.8%	—
17	17.0	5 (29%)	7.5 44.1%	4.25 25.0%	2.5 14.7%	1.5 8.8%	1.25 7.4%	—
18	18.0	5 (28%)	8.0 44.4%	4.5 25.0%	2.75 15.3%	1.5 8.3%	1.25 6.9%	—
19	19.0	6 (32%)	8.0 42.1%	4.25 22.4%	2.25 11.8%	1.75 9.2%	1.5 7.9%	1.25 6.6%
20	20.0	6 (30%)	8.5 42.5%	4.5 22.5%	2.5 12.5%	1.75 8.8%	1.5 7.5%	1.25 6.3%